

sades. He also includes dioceses in lands evangelized during Latin medieval expansion into the Crimea, Georgia, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Persia, India, Central Asia, and China that ended in the first half of the fourteenth century, but listing the appointment of an archbishop for Beijing as late as 1426 (p. 73). Fedalto limits himself to bishops who resided in their sees or at least could have, given the political situation. Once the territories were retaken by the Arabs, Ottomans, or Byzantines, Latin prelates usually were no longer able to reside in their sees and they lived in the West, becoming titular bishops *in partibus infidelium* or *schismatorum*. On some Aegean islands the Latin church survived after the Ottoman conquests mostly of the sixteenth century or after the island became a tributary state of the Ottomans, with the archbishop of Naxos now receiving his red *berat* from the sultan and a bishop remaining on Tino. Nonetheless, Fedalto terminates his listing with the fall of Western political control of the islands. In the case of Nazareth and Bethlehem that continued to have lands in the West annexed to them (e.g., near Bari), Fedalto terminates his listing of prelates once the crusaders lost control of their Palestinian lands. For a listing of the titular bishops one should consult the Eubel series. Fedalto differs from that series by also listing the bishops appointed by the Avignonese and Pisan popes and by having recourse to non-Vatican documents such as chronicles to document the presence of bishops who were elected or appointed locally with metropolitan rather than papal confirmation. At times Rome appointed its own rival candidate who could not secure possession of the church. The volume concludes with indices of personal names organized alphabetically by their first names, of sees and localities, and of the division of patriarchates into metropolitan provinces subdivided into dioceses.

The second edition is about twenty pages longer with an updated bibliography (pp. 17-27) and new references, where relevant, for each diocese. Fedalto documents the presence of additional bishops (e.g., for Mopsuestia, Megara, Mytilene, Naxivan, etc.) and updates the present political divisions, especially following the fall of the Soviet Union. Given the new information contained in the second edition, it should replace the earlier one. Scholars are indebted to Fedalto for his pains-taking labors.

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*Oltre Cîteaux: Gioacchino da Fiore e l'Ordine fiorense.* By Valeria De Fraja. [Centro Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti S. Giovanni in Fiore: Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, Testi e strumenti, 19.] (Rome: Viella. 2006. Pp. 301, 2 color plates. €30.00 paperback.)

The Transfiguration in Matthew 17:1-13 is a touchstone of Western mysticism and of the churches' approach to mystical experience. The Apostles witness an event far beyond their comprehension, an irruption of the divine that transforms flesh, time, and space. Their immediate impulse is to build "taber-

nacles” to commemorate the event, but Jesus warns them, “tell no one about this vision.” Joachim of Fiore’s own attempts to corporealize his deeply mystical understanding resulted in a series of *figurae* that inspired generations of followers after his death and have fascinated and puzzled scholars ever since. Do these *figurae* express the progression of the three great ages, as the consensus holds? Might they, as Caroline Bruzelius and I have suggested, provide literal models for architecture—Sta. Chiara in Naples, for example?

Valeria De Fraja’s groundbreaking work offers another interpretation, one that takes seriously the obligation of the textual scholar to *de-construct* these verbal and visual *mansions*—parsing and reassembling their language within their time and place. This detailed, well annotated and documented analysis demonstrates the merits of close reading of the texts and *figurae* and of the contexts of their production. It is the outcome of several articles and a dissertation completed under the guidance of Gian Luca Potestà and Roberto Rusconi, reflecting the influence of Herbert Grundmann throughout.

De Fraja’s hypothesis is that beyond being solely the product of a deeply mystical intuition of the turning of the ages—of high theory or mystical intuition—Joachim’s *figurae* (at least tables XII, the *Dispositio novi ordinis* under study here, and XIII, the twin trees) are the result of praxis: of his reflection in the 1180s and 1190s on the task of reforming Cistercian monasticism and building a new order in the Regno of Naples under the late Normans and early Hohenstaufen and in the context of declining Greek monasticism and the reforms of Innocent III. These *figurae* are not—or not only—expositions of universal patterns, of biblical concordances of old and new, but working instructions, visualizations of how an abbot ought to set up a new order that would incorporate harmoniously the three major spiritual communities common to the South at the time (monks, clerics, *and* laity) with a series of houses, out-buildings, and oratories. Joachim’s “mansions” may enshrine deep mystery, but they derive from practical community planning by an engaged and politically astute churchman. This is not to rob Joachim of his spiritual and historical significance: both for Joachim and his followers these schemata embodied mysteries of time and space far beyond the quotidian. De Fraja stresses that they were to incorporate the plan of the heavenly Jerusalem on earth. Nor has De Fraja made Joachim a twelfth-century organizational guru. Instead, she has provided us with a sound philological approach to Joachim’s corpus: taking his words and images as far and as literally as an informed and close reading will allow. Whatever his followers speculated on his works over the next centuries, De Fraja’s Joachim derived his high theory from praxis and on-the-ground experience.

There are caveats for De Fraja’s argument that she acknowledges: the textual evidence from Joachim’s work is fragmentary; the documentation she appends for Joachim’s foundations is sometimes equivocal; the innovations he sets forth in his schemata were not startlingly new for his time or place, and Joachim’s followers failed to incorporate his practical achievements. Nonetheless, De Fraja’s

thesis, however measured, is compelling. Students of Joachimism and of late medieval spirituality should engage with this book and reflect on the deeply intertwined visibles and invisibles that she perceives here.

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*Disegni dei tempi. Il "Liber Figurarum" e la teologia figurativa di Gioacchino da Fiore.* By Marco Rainini. [Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, Testi e strumenti, 18.] (Rome: Viella. 2006. Pp. xvi, 333. €35 paperback.)

In 1936 Monsignor Leone Tondelli discovered a peculiar book of illuminations in a closet in the seminary at Reggio Emilia, and in 1942 Fritz Saxl drew attention to a similar manuscript in Corpus Christi College, Oxford. These two manuscripts, as well as a third discovered in Dresden, were identified with the *Liber Figurarum* (LF) attributed to Joachim of Fiore in some thirteenth-century sources. In 1953 Tondelli and two Oxford medievalists, Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, collaborated on a facsimile edition, transcription, and study of the LF, and in 1972 the latter two produced an impressive monograph on *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*. As Reeves said, "It is not too much to say that the discovery of the *Liber Figurarum* has initiated a new phase in Joachimist studies" (p. vi).

Scholarship on the three manuscripts, as well as the numerous other *figurae* connected with Joachim, both those in the margins of his written works and shorter collections of pictures, has not stood still. In the past fifteen years numerous essays have been devoted to the collection and to many of the individual *figurae*. Greater precision about the events of Joachim's life and the development and dating of his writings, especially as found in Gian Luca Potestà's *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Giacchino da Fiore* (2004), also invites a reconsideration of this central element in Joachim's thought. Marco Rainini has profited from the new scholarship to produce a re-evaluation of the LF that pays respect to the pioneering work of Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, but that differs from their views in important ways.

Rainini locates Joachim's use of *figurae* to express his difficult teachings within the perspective of twelfth-century interest in "visual exegesis," or "figurative theology," such as that found in Hugh of St. Victor (Chapter 1). His efforts to uncover sources for Joachim's images have the effect of revealing the Calabrian abbot to be less of a bizarre and marginal figure than was imagined in the past, but someone well read and aware of many contemporary and traditional theological resources, as well a person in intimate contact with the papal curia. At times, Rainini may have overlooked some useful possibilities. For example, in discussing the antecedents to the abbot's double sequences of persecutions of the Old and New Testaments (pp. 87-89), he misses the witness of Augustine's pupil Quodvultdeus, the earliest appearance of such attempts at concordances between the two Testaments.